

AK.5 Forms & Documents Index

Every document an Alaska owner-builder meets — what each one is, when it is needed, and which office it comes from — and the file you build in place of the certificate most of this state never issues.

Before you use this document

This is a process reference, not legal advice. Alaska has no statewide residential building code and, over most of its land area, no local building department either — so what binds your house is a short stack of *state* rules that apply whether or not anyone inspects, plus whatever your borough, your city, your lender and your utility require on top. Confirm every item with the office that will actually decide it before you rely on it. Where a borough or city issues your permit, its own forms govern. The obligations behind them do not change.

Documents an Alaska owner-builder will encounter

Document	What it is and when you need it	Where it comes from
Contractor registration search	Not a form — the free lookup that tells you whether anyone you are about to pay is registered, and whether a general contractor holds the residential contractor endorsement required for work on a one-to four-unit dwelling. When: before signing anything, and print the result.	commerce.alaska.gov → Corporations, Business and Professional Licensing → Search Licenses
Owner-builder notice under AS 08.18.161(11)	The one form the exemption itself names. Required if you advertise for sale or sell the structure during construction or within two years after construction <i>begins</i> . Filing it obliges the department to investigate whether you are running a contracting business (AS 08.18.116(b)). When: on advertising or sale inside the window.	Department of Commerce, Community, and Economic Development, on its own form
Geotechnical investigation report	Required by no Alaska permit and by every honest assessment of the ground. The document that tells you whether you are founding on ice-rich permafrost, on a liquefiable soil, or on a slope. When: before you buy the land if you can, before you design if you cannot.	A geotechnical engineering firm
Survey and plot plan	Boundaries, the building envelope, the wastewater system <i>and its reserve area</i> , the well, and the driveway, drawn together. Required by local departments; needed everywhere else because these four compete for the same ground and the separation distances are fixed.	A land surveyor registered in Alaska

Documents an Alaska owner-builder will encounter

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DEC homeowner installer approval	Only if you will install the septic system yourself. Complete DEC's training course, apply, and pay the \$275 fee. It authorizes one system within a one-year period on your own owner-occupied residence. When: before any excavation — installing without it or a certified installer is barred outright.	Alaska DEC — dec.alaska.gov → Water → Wastewater → Onsite
24-hour construction notification	For a system that needs no plan approval, this replaces the permit: notify DEC " <i>at least one day before beginning construction</i> " on its form. When: the day before you dig.	Alaska DEC, on its own form
Documentation of Construction	The 90-day registration that closes out an exempt system — the form, the installer's signature or engineer's seal, photographs of eight specified stages , and the \$115 fee. Miss it and the fix is an engineer-sealed adequacy report on a buried system. When: within 90 days of completing installation.	Alaska DEC — filed through its online system
Approval to Construct, and certification of construction	The plan-review path instead, for an alternative system, a permafrost site or anything needing a waiver. DEC acts within 30 days; the approval is void if the work is not finished in two years; the certification of construction and record drawings are due within 60 days of completion. Plan review to 1,500 gpd: \$655 .	Alaska DEC, on engineer-prepared submittals
Well log	The driller's record of depth, casing, static level and yield. Filing it is mandatory — within 45 days, with both the owner and the Department of Natural Resources — and the duty falls on " <i>a person who constructs the well,</i> " so it is yours if you drill it yourself. Keep your copy; it is searchable later but easiest now.	Your driller, filed with Alaska DNR
Water test results	What to test for depends on your area and on what your lender wants; arsenic is a genuine concern in parts of Alaska. Ask the office regulating your wastewater system and your lender, and keep every result with its date.	A certified laboratory
Driveway or access permit	For a tie-in to a state-maintained road, the Alaska Department of Transportation and Public Facilities; for a borough or city road, that government. On a private road, a recorded easement and the road association's rules instead. When: before you cut the approach.	Alaska DOT&PF — dot.alaska.gov — or your borough or city
Floodplain development permit	Required in a mapped special flood hazard area in a community that participates in the National Flood Insurance Program — including communities with no building code at all . Riverine and ice-jam flooding are ordinary Alaska risks.	The community's floodplain administrator

Documents an Alaska owner-builder will encounter

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Section 404 wetlands permit or determination	Alaska holds an enormous share of the country's wetlands, and filling or grading in one without authorization is a federal matter. Get a determination before you design the driveway and the pad, not after. When: at the site-planning stage.	U.S. Army Corps of Engineers, Alaska District
911 address assignment	Free, slow, and a prerequisite for utility service, deliveries and emergency response. Request it as soon as you own the parcel.	Borough or city addressing office
Zoning or land use permit	Setbacks, height, accessory buildings, waterfront and habitat setbacks. This exists in Alaska boroughs that have no building code whatsoever , which is why "no building permit" never means "no permit."	Borough or city planning department
State plumbing permit	Where your community is at or above 2,500 population , the state plumbing code applies to new construction and the Department of Labor issues permits and inspects. The statutory fee ceiling is \$2.00 to issue plus \$1.50 per fixture — confirm what is actually charged.	DOLWD Labor Standards and Safety, Mechanical Inspection — labor.alaska.gov
Boiler or pressure vessel installation notice	Required within 30 days of installation — but the department's form scopes it to " <i>any commercial or residential (six families) site,</i> " so a detached house is outside it and you file nothing. Know the rule anyway: the statute is broader than the form, and an unusual pressure vessel is worth one call. See AK.2.	DOLWD Mechanical Inspection — only at six families or more
Smoke and carbon monoxide alarm record	Not a form anyone will collect — but photograph the installed alarms, keep the receipts and note the model numbers. They are required in every dwelling unit in the state , and this is a five-minute record that answers a question an insurer or a buyer may well ask.	You, at final
Local building permit and inspection card	Only where a borough or city reviews your house. The card lists the inspections <i>your</i> job requires and governs over any sequence printed anywhere, including AK.3.	Your local building department
Certificate of occupancy	Issued only by a local building department. Most Alaska owner-builders never receive one , and its absence is normal rather than suspicious. Note the one place it does real work: a certificate from an AHFC-approved municipality substitutes for the PUR-102 inspection summary. Ask whether yours is on that list.	Your local building department, if you have one

Documents an Alaska owner-builder will encounter

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Certificate of On-Site Systems Approval (COSA)	Anchorage only , and required at nearly every transfer of a property served by a well or septic system — the certificate lenders and older paperwork still call the HAA. A private engineer performs it: a septic adequacy test, the tank pumped within 12 months, a surveyed as-built, a well yield test, and lab tests for coliform, arsenic and nitrate. When: before you sell.	Municipality of Anchorage On-Site Water and Wastewater Section
PUR-102 Summary of Building Inspections	The document that stands in for a certificate of occupancy on a state-financed house — signed stage by stage across the five statutory inspections, then recorded . It also carries the Exempt Builder's Certification on which an owner-builder certifies they have not built another structure in the prior two years. When: throughout construction; recorded at the end.	An AHFC-authorized inspector; recorded with the recorder's office
PUR-101 BEES Certification	The energy half. Completed only by an AHFC-authorized energy rater using the state's modeling software — you cannot self-certify. When: book the rater during design; raters are scarce off the road system.	An AHFC-authorized energy rater
Lender's construction standard and inspection reports	If you are borrowing outside AHFC, get the standard in writing before you draw and keep every draw inspection report — collectively they are the closest thing to an inspection history your house will have. On a federally-backed loan the substitute for a permit and certificate is three inspections by a qualified third party. See AK.2, Step 4.	Your lender, in writing
Seller's disclosure statement	At resale. See the box below — there is a real exemption for a first sale of a never-occupied house, and the penalties for getting it wrong run to treble damages.	Alaska Real Estate Commission form, from the transferor

THE DISCLOSURE RULE AT RESALE — AND ITS REAL EXEMPTION

Alaska requires a seller of residential real property to deliver a completed written disclosure statement, on the Real Estate Commission's form, **before the buyer makes a written offer**. Guides state that much and stop. Two sections later there is an exemption that applies to a great many owner-builders and almost never gets printed.

First sale, never occupied — and what happens if you move in

*"This chapter does not apply to the transfer of an interest in residential real property if the transfer is the **first transfer** of the property and if the property has **never been occupied**." (AS 34.70.120)*

Both conditions, together. Build a house and sell it before anyone lives in it and the disclosure chapter does not reach the sale. Live in it for a winter and sell it and the chapter applies in full — which is the far commoner owner-builder story, and the one worth planning for. Note how this interacts with **AK.1**: the same house sold early enough to escape the disclosure statute is a house sold inside the two-year window that obliges you to file the AS 08.18.161(11) notice. The two rules pull in opposite directions, and knowing that before you list is worth more than knowing it after.

Where the chapter does apply, the penalties are not nominal. A person who **negligently** violates it "*is liable to the transferee for the amount of the actual damages*"; a person who "*wilfully*" violates it — the statute's own spelling — is liable "*for up to **three times** the actual damages*," plus costs and attorney fees. The chapter can also be waived by written agreement between the parties (AS 34.70.110) — which is a thing buyers sometimes propose and sellers should think about carefully rather than sign.

None of this asks you to flag the house as owner-built. It asks you to disclose what you **know** about its condition. An owner-builder knows more about the house than any other seller in the market — which is exactly why the build record in the next section is worth keeping.

AS 34.70.010; AS 34.70.050; AS 34.70.090(b), (c); AS 34.70.110; AS 34.70.120; AS 34.70.200(3) — "residential real property" means property whose primary purpose is a single-family dwelling, or two single-family dwellings in one building. Read at akleg.gov, August 2026.

THE FILE YOU BUILD INSTEAD OF A CERTIFICATE

In most of the country the certificate of occupancy is the artifact that says a house was built properly. Most Alaska owner-builders will never hold one, and there is nothing wrong with that — but something has to do that job when the appraiser, the underwriter or the buyer arrives. What does the job is a file you assemble as you go, and it is almost impossible to assemble afterwards.

Keep it in one place, keep two copies, and put one somewhere that will survive the house. The single highest-value item on the list is the cheapest: **photographs of every wall, floor and ceiling cavity taken the day before it was closed up**, with the date intact.

The build record — assemble as you go

	Item	Date	Where it is kept
☐	Dated photographs of every stage, especially every cavity before it was covered — framing, insulation, air barrier, plumbing, wiring		
☐	The AK.3 stage log, filled in as it happened rather than from memory		

The build record — assemble as you go

	Item	Date	Where it is kept
☐	Geotechnical report and the foundation design that responds to it Filed: _____		
☐	Wastewater approval, the as-built, and the certification of completion Filed: _____		
☐	Well log and every water test result, with dates Filed: _____		
☐	Structural engineer's sealed drawings and calculations		
☐	Energy documentation: the rating or model, the air-sealing approach, and what the ventilation system is		
☐	Every state or local permit, inspection report and correction notice, including the ones you passed		
☐	Lender's draw inspection reports, in order		
☐	Manufacturer documentation and warranties for the heating system, the ventilation equipment, the windows and the roof		
☐	Receipts and model numbers for the smoke and carbon monoxide alarms		
☐	Contractor registration printouts for everyone you paid, with the dates you checked them Filed: _____		

Sources — every Alaska claim in this document (verified August 2026)

What this document states	Authority
The exemption's own notice form, and the investigation that filing it triggers	AS 08.18.161(11); AS 08.18.116(b)
Residential contractor endorsement is required of a general contractor for one- to four-unit residential work	AS 08.18.025(a)
State plumbing permits and the statutory fee ceiling of \$2.00 to issue plus \$1.50 per fixture	8 AAC 63.020; AS 18.60.720(a)

Sources — every Alaska claim in this document (verified August 2026)

What this document states	Authority
The boiler installation notice is scoped by the department's own form to commercial and six-family-or-larger residential sites — a detached house files nothing	AS 18.60.200(b); DOLWD form
Smoke and carbon monoxide alarms in all dwelling units in the state	AS 18.70.095
Seller's disclosure statement before a written offer, on the Real Estate Commission's form	AS 34.70.010; AS 34.70.050
The chapter does not apply to a first transfer of property that has never been occupied	AS 34.70.120
Negligent violation: actual damages. Wilful: up to treble damages plus costs and fees. The chapter may be waived in writing	AS 34.70.090(b), (c); AS 34.70.110

Read any statute or regulation cited above free at **akleg.gov** → Bills & Laws → Alaska Statutes for an **AS** citation, or → Alaska Administrative Code for an **AAC** citation. Both are searchable by number — type 08.18.161 or 18 AAC 72 into the section box. Every quotation here was read there and verified August 2026 against the Alaska Statutes 2025 compilation.